



"How to Live Long and Well",
July 30, 2007

**"It is pure arithmetic:
One should add more
happiness, subtract
tensions, divide worries
and multiply exercises
to live long and
maintain good health."**

K. CHIDANAND KUMAR, *on e-mail*

Age-old Wisdom

The cover story is informative ("How to Live Long and Well", July 30). While modern science and technology have contributed immensely towards longevity, our ancient wisdom emphasises on four things to live long: (i) Reduce your food intake by half as you age; (ii) Drink double the amount of water; (iii) Increase physical exercise three times and; (iv) Laugh four times more.

GOVIND SINGH KHIMT, *Simla*

The well-researched guide to good health rightly laid emphasis on fitness rather than slimness. It is unfortunate that today's generation associates beauty with slimness. Be it beauty pageants or advertisements, all television programmes seem to be promoting only one concept: thin is beautiful.

B. JYOTI KIRAN, *Bhopal*

With a plethora of diet plans and exercise options, it has become difficult for today's youngsters to differentiate between right and wrong. To stayfit, one doesn't necessarily need to stick to a diet plan or do rigorous exercises. A brisk walk can work as well. The actual prescription to live long is will-power.

H.R. BAPU SATYANARAYANA,
Mysore

Your magazine seems to be running out of news ideas. Although thought provoking, your guide to good health did not deserve such a mammoth display. Also, you need not have carried such an obscene picture on the cover of the magazine to impart how to live long and well.

MANAS RANJAN DASH, *on e-mail*

In an age of careening careers and boardroom battles, it is rightly said that ardours are cooling in bedrooms across urban

India. Young professionals are more interested in losing their health and making money. What they don't realise is that one day they will lose all their money in a bid to restore their health.

MAN MOHAN BHATIA, *Delhi*

Most traditional *thalis*—rich in carbohydrates, vitamins, calcium and iron—are considered wholesome and nutritious as they comprise cereals, pulses, vegetables, dairy and animal protein. This only shows how wrong modern diets are that tell people to keep off cereals.

K.R. RAVI, *on e-mail*

In India, where lifestyles and eating habits of people have changed for the worse, your guide to living long hasn't come a day too soon. What made interesting reading, however, were experiences of the six centenarians which substantiated the

prescription for longevity—adopting healthy lifestyles with adequate exercise and sleep and a healthy diet. Longevity has no meaning if one is neglected in old age.

NALINI VIJAYARAGHAVAN,
on e-mail

Pragmatic Policies

It's high time the Indian Government took a tough stand against the US and the EU on the issue of subsidies ("A Skewed Blame Game", July 30). However, it should not let the Left tweak economic policies. Pragmatism should prevail.

ROBINJYOTI TALUKDAR,
Tihu (Assam)

Fuss Over a Kiss

An entertainment channel showing a kiss is still tolerable ("Drama and Mascara", July 30). But why was a news channel interviewing Aditya Narayan about how he was feeling after being kissed?